

Q HOW DOES AN IMPROVED MIND-BODY CONNECTION HELP ME MANAGE STRESS?

Because yoga includes practices that engage both your mind and body, it helps you to regulate your system through both top-down and bottom-up pathways. Enhancing your mind-body and body-mind connections increases your ability

to self-regulate and improves your resilience (your ability to bounce back after stress via homeostasis, the body's self-regulation of internal conditions). This all occurs partly due to the complex workings of your vagus nerve (see pp.190–91).

NEUROCOGNITIVE (MIND-BODY) PATHWAY

1 Meditation, mindful movement, and intentional living based on the philosophical teachings of yoga increase your attention

2 Increased attention regulates your nervous system and helps you maintain homeostasis more efficiently

NEUROPHYSIOLOGICAL (BODY-MIND) PATHWAY

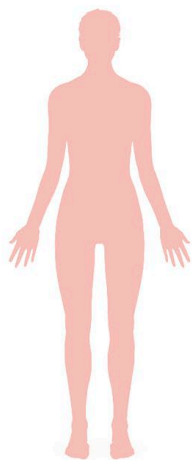
1 Yoga practices such as asanas, mudras, and pranayama, give you internal body awareness (interoception)

2 This interoceptive information affects your autonomic nervous system (ANS), which changes your thoughts and neural pathways, building your brain and improving self-regulation

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Enhancing your mind-body and body-mind connection increases your ability to self-regulate and improves your resilience.

Did you know?



HANS SELYE COINED THE TERM “**STRESS**” IN 1936 TO DESCRIBE THE BODY’S **RESPONSE TO CHANGE**. HE IDENTIFIED TWO TYPES OF STRESS: **EUSTRESS**, WHICH IS BENEFICIAL STRESS, SUCH AS AN ENGAGING WORK PROJECT; AND **DISTRESS**, WHICH IS REAL OR IMAGINED STRESS THAT PUTS MORE PRESSURE ON YOUR SYSTEM.

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